



AdvisePoint Docs

User Guide

Application version 1.2.7

Document revision 1.2.7 · September 18, 2026

A local search tool for technical manuals and admin guides.

Everything runs on your own laptop. No internet required after install.

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Chapter 1

System Requirements

Check these before you install so nothing surprises you later.

Operating system

- Windows 10 (64-bit) or Windows 11 (64-bit) on an Intel or AMD x64 processor. This build is x64 only.

Disk space

- About 500 MB free for the app folder itself.
- Additional room in %LOCALAPPDATA%\AdvisePoint Docs\ for your library. A rough guide: budget 3-4x the total size of the documents you plan to upload, which covers the SQLite database, rendered page images, and the original files kept for viewing.
- If you use Scheduled Backups, budget extra room for the backup destination folder as well - retention keeps N ZIPs on disk, each roughly the size of your current library.

Memory

- 4 GB RAM minimum, 8 GB recommended if you plan to upload large PDFs (500+ pages) or work with several hundred documents.

Display

- 1366 x 768 or larger. The Library, Query, and Settings pages are designed for a laptop-class screen; smaller windows still work but the filter rail may compress.

Browser

- The app runs in your default web browser at `http://127.0.0.1:5000`. Modern Chromium-based browsers (Chrome, Microsoft Edge) and Firefox are supported. The in-app PDF viewer and the Ctrl+F in-document search need a current browser build; Internet Explorer is not supported.

Network

- No internet connection is required after install. All parsing, indexing, and searching happen locally on the same machine.
- Optional outbound access to `github.com` is used only when you open Settings > System to check for a newer release, or when you install one via the built-in updater.

Permissions

- A regular Windows user account is enough. No administrator rights are required to run the app or to install updates - the updater writes into the app folder you extracted, and the library lives under your own %LOCALAPPDATA%.
- You need normal write access to the folder you extracted the app into and to your %LOCALAPPDATA%. Shared or read-only locations are not suitable install targets.

What's bundled - nothing extra to install

- The Node.js 20 LTS runtime the server needs is shipped inside the app folder. There is no separate Node.js install to manage.
- The SQLite database engine, PDF extractor, and DOCX/RTF parsers are all included. The app does not download runtime components at first launch.

Optional: SmartScreen and antivirus

- See "**Setup Icon (run once).bat**" in Chapter 2 and the Troubleshooting chapter for the one-time SmartScreen prompt and antivirus exclusion notes. Neither is a hard requirement but both make the first launch smoother.

HELP — SIZING THE LIBRARY FOLDER

Uploaded documents live under %LOCALAPPDATA%\AdvisePoint Docs, not inside the app folder. If your system drive is tight, make sure %LOCALAPPDATA% has room for roughly three to four times the total size of the documents you plan to index.

Chapter 2

Quick Start

1. Extract this folder somewhere convenient, for example: C:\Tools\AdvisePoint Docs
2. FIRST TIME ONLY: Double-click "**Setup Icon (run once).bat**" This does two things:
 - Clears Windows' "**downloaded from the internet**" flag from every file in the folder. This removes the SmartScreen popups you'd otherwise see every time the app launches.
 - Creates an "**AdvisePoint Docs**" shortcut with the app icon that launches the app with no command window.

You may see ONE "**Windows protected your PC**" popup for this .bat itself - click "**More info**" then "**Run anyway**". After it finishes you shouldn't see the popup again.

Even if you skip step 2 and launch the app directly, "Start AdvisePoint Docs.bat" will self-unblock the folder on first run so the SmartScreen popup only shows up once instead of on every launch.

3. Double-click the new "**AdvisePoint Docs**" shortcut. Your browser opens at <http://127.0.0.1:5000> with the app already loaded. No command window appears - the server runs invisibly in the background.
4. When you are done, close the browser tab. To fully stop the server, right-click the AdvisePoint Docs entry in Task Manager and choose End Task, or just log off / restart your PC.

Optional: after step 2, you can drag the "**AdvisePoint Docs**" shortcut to your Desktop or right-click and Pin to Taskbar for one-click access.

If the shortcut doesn't work for any reason, you can always fall back to double-clicking "**Start AdvisePoint Docs.bat**" - same result.

Your database lives in %LOCALAPPDATA%\AdvisePoint Docs\ so any documents you upload stick around between sessions.

TIP — PIN IT ONCE, LAUNCH IT FOREVER

After setup, right-click the AdvisePoint Docs shortcut and choose Pin to Taskbar. From then on the app is one click away, and the browser opens straight to the interface.

Chapter 3

Updating

You have two ways to install a new build:

- **IN-APP UPDATER** (recommended for point releases) Open Settings > System. If a newer release is on GitHub the panel shows the version and release notes. Click **"Install and restart"** and the app fetches, verifies, and swaps in the new build for you. If a background server is still running from an old launch, the updater identifies it and offers to shut it down cleanly first; it never touches an unrelated process that happens to use port 5000. When the swap is complete the updater relaunches the app automatically - no extra window to close, no manual restart.

You can also drag-and-drop a downloaded ZIP directly onto the Updates panel to install it without going to GitHub. Handy for a hotfix build that isn't a public release, or for machines that can't reach github.com.

- **COMMAND-LINE UPDATER** Double-click **"Update AdvisePoint Docs.bat"** in the app folder. Same fetch, verify, and swap as the in-app path, run from a console window instead. Useful if the app won't start at all.

Whichever path you use, your database, uploaded documents, saved searches, and settings under %LOCALAPPDATA%\AdvisePoint Docs\ are never replaced. The previous application build is retained temporarily as dist.bak so the updater can restore it automatically if the swap fails. Each successful update replaces the prior dist.bak; backup folders do not accumulate.

POST-RESTORE GUIDANCE (new in 1.2.3)

When a restore finishes, the app now shows a completion dialog that spells out what happened, where the pre-restore snapshot lives (for a Wipe & Replace restore), and how the Recovery panel's **"Delete all"** action interacts with the restore. Delete all in Recovery operates on the library that exists AFTER the restore, so it removes what the restore just added -- it does not undo the restore or return you to the pre-restore state. To roll back, close AdvisePoint Docs, rename the timestamped .bak folder next to your data directory over the current data folder, and restart.

The same information is preserved to a small file next to your data directory (AdvisePoint Docs.last-op.json) so that if the app is force-closed before you dismiss the dialog, the next time you open the Settings > System tab, a banner surfaces the same message. The banner appears at most once per restore and is removed as soon as you see it.

UPDATER --allow-same-version FLAG (new in 1.2.3)

The command-line updater accepts --allow-same-version to permit reinstalling the same version that is already installed. Downgrades remain refused. Intended for developer repairs of a corrupted install and for reproducing a build during testing without having to bump the version number.

Example:

```
"C:\Program Files\AdvisePoint Docs\update.exe" --local-zip  
C:\Path\To\AdvisePoint-Docs-1.2.3.zip --allow-same-version
```

LOCAL-ZIP INTEGRITY CHECK (new in 1.2.2)

When you drop a downloaded update zip onto the Updates panel or point the command-line updater at one, the updater now verifies the file before touching your installation:

- If a companion hash file (<zipname>.sha256 or SHA256SUMS.txt) sits in the same folder as the update zip, the updater hashes the zip and refuses to install on mismatch.
- If no companion hash file exists, the updater walks the entire zip once and verifies every entry without writing anything. Any corrupt entry stops the install cleanly before your app folder is touched.

On failure the updater prints an explicit **"the update file on your disk is damaged"** message with the mismatched hashes (or the failing entry name), and instructs you to redownload rather than retry against the same corrupt copy. This addresses the failure pattern where an in-flight file corruption -- from a bad USB thumbdrive, network share, or interrupted download -- surfaced only after the updater had begun extracting, and read to users as a generic **"try again"** prompt.

Transferring the Update Zip to an Offline Machine

If you need to move the update ZIP from one machine to another -- for example, because the target laptop can't reach the internet during the install -- treat the transfer as untrusted and verify the copy before you install.

Good transfer methods, most reliable first:

- Direct download on the target machine. Skips every intermediate step. Preferred whenever the target can reach the download page.
- Cloud drop (OneDrive, Dropbox, Google Drive, iCloud Drive). Upload from the source machine, download on the target. These services verify bytes end-to-end on both transfers.
- SMB network share between the two machines on the same trusted network.

Acceptable, but verify afterwards:

- USB thumbdrive formatted as exFAT or NTFS with a full format (not a quick format). Cheap or old thumbdrives can silently return bad bytes on the largest files inside the ZIP, and the updater will refuse to install a damaged file rather than write a broken binary to your app folder. Ejecting the drive properly is required but not sufficient - the stick itself has to be healthy.

Avoid:

- USB thumbdrives formatted as FAT32. FAT32 has no journaling and no per-block integrity, and the observed failure mode of a corrupt ZIP arriving at the target machine has always traced back to a FAT32 stick when USB was involved.

How to verify the copy is intact (recommended for any USB transfer):

1. On the SOURCE machine, right after downloading, open PowerShell and run: `Get-FileHash "<path-to-zip>" -Algorithm SHA256` Copy the 64-character hash somewhere.

2. On the TARGET machine, after the copy arrives, run the same command against the copy. Compare the two hashes character for character.
3. If the two hashes match, install with confidence. If they differ, the file was corrupted somewhere in the transfer - do NOT run the updater against the damaged file. Redownload or use a different transfer method.

A <zipname>.sha256 file shipped alongside each release makes step 2 trivial: run Get-FileHash on the target machine and compare it to the one line inside the .sha256 file.

If you install without verifying and the updater refuses the ZIP with the "**update file on your disk is damaged**" message, the transfer is the first place to look - not the build. The same shipped build has already installed successfully on other machines.

Chapter 4

Install Location - Recommended Folder Setup

Extract the AdvisePoint Docs folder to a plain local path like:

```
C:\AdvisePoint Docs\  
D:\AdvisePoint Docs\  
C:\Tools\AdvisePoint Docs\
```

Do NOT extract or move it into:

```
OneDrive (personal or business)  
Dropbox  
Google Drive  
iCloud Drive  
Box / Box Sync  
Any network path starting with \\server\share
```

Why this matters:

- Cloud-sync tools can mark files as online-only placeholders. When the app or your browser tries to open one, the sync client has to fetch it first, which can time out or fail silently.
- Corporate OneDrive tenants often apply Data Loss Prevention (DLP) rules that block uploads to loopback services like this app. Symptom: the Upload tab shows "**Failed to fetch**" and no request ever reaches the server.
- Sync clients hold short-lived file locks while a file is being written. Backups written into a sync folder can corrupt mid-write.
- Files inherit the Mark-of-the-Web from the sync source, so SmartScreen popups keep coming back even after Setup Icon.

The app auto-detects the most common problem paths and shows an amber banner at the top of the window when it's running from one of them. The banner links back here and can be dismissed per location. It reappears if you later move the app to a different problem folder.

If the app is already installed inside a cloud-sync folder:

1. Close the app (Task Manager -> AdvisePoint Docs -> End task, or right-click the taskbar icon -> Close).
2. Move (not copy) the "**AdvisePoint Docs**" folder to a plain local path like C:\AdvisePoint Docs\.
3. Re-run "**Setup Icon (run once).bat**" from the new location so the desktop shortcut points at the right place.
4. Launch the app. Your uploaded documents are unaffected because they live in %LOCALAPPDATA%\AdvisePoint Docs\, which is outside the app folder and outside typical cloud-sync paths.

WARNING — DO NOT INSTALL INTO A CLOUD-SYNC FOLDER

OneDrive, Dropbox, Google Drive, iCloud, and Box can mark files as online-only, hold write locks on the database, or trip DLP rules that block uploads. Keep the app on a plain local drive.

Chapter 5

Adding Your Own Documents

1. Click the Upload tab.
2. Drag a PDF, DOCX, RTF, TXT, or Markdown file onto the drop zone (or click the drop zone to browse for one).
3. Check the Product model field. AdvisePoint Docs suggests one from the filename; correct it if needed, or leave it blank for documents that aren't model-specific. This is what makes filtered searches work later.
4. Fill in whatever other metadata is useful - product family, firmware version, document type, confidentiality level, audience, tags.
5. Click Upload.

The file is parsed, split into searchable excerpts, and indexed locally. Nothing is uploaded anywhere. Max file size is 150 MB.

Tip: the Tags field autocompletes from tags you've used before, so similar documents end up with consistent labels.

Use Select folder... to choose a whole folder, or drag a folder onto Upload. Both paths gather PDF, DOCX, RTF, TXT, MD, and MARKDOWN files from its subfolders, up to 150 MB per file. Unsupported and oversized files are listed in a summary; hidden files and OS bookkeeping entries are ignored. Files are staged for review before upload.

Fix Title is available beside Title on Upload and in the Library's Edit document dialog. It suggests a readable title from the original filename, never from the current title. If the title was hand-edited, compare the current and proposed wording before choosing Replace. The button remains available after use, and repeated clicks give the same suggestion. Older documents without a stored filename do not show the button. In Library, Save commits the edited title; Cancel leaves the document unchanged.

Joined task words such as CloudPrintandScan become Cloud Print and Scan. This uses conservative matching for "**and**"; unfamiliar compounds may still need manual spacing rather than risking changes to ordinary words.

HELP — GETTING THE MOST OUT OF METADATA

Product model is optional, but it's the primary way filtered searches narrow down results, so fill it in when a document belongs to specific machines. The Upload tab suggests it from the filename, and you can leave it blank for documents that aren't model-specific, like price lists or software notes. Tags autocomplete from what you've used before, so similar documents naturally end up with matching labels — which makes them easier to find later.

Chapter 6

Settings

Settings has four tabs, in this order:

- System - installed version and updates, viewer preferences, Welcome Guide and Manage values side by side on wide windows, Library scan, and diagnostics. A pending restore notice appears first when present.
- Formats - Document types, Filename codes, and Filename phrases.
- Backup / Restore - backup controls, Recovery (including pre-restore snapshots), duplicates, and interrupted or failed renders.
- Developer - Fields, Filter mapping, and Examples on one page.

System opens by default. This organization changes where controls appear, not the saved settings or library data.

Chapter 7

Searching

1. Click the Query tab.
2. Type a natural-language question like: **"How do I configure LDAP authentication?" "What are the paper size limits on the MZ9500ci?" "Steps to reset the fuser count"**
3. Use the filter panel on the left to narrow results.
4. Match mode: Smart - blended keyword + semantic (default; recommended) Phrase - exact-phrase match Semantic - meaning-based match only

Filters available on the left rail:

- Product family - the top-level product line the document belongs to. Independent from Product model, so you can pick any family/model combination. Documents that don't have a family recorded are always included when a family is picked, so older uploads that pre-date the field don't drop out. The filter is hidden when no document in your library has a family recorded.
- Product model
- Document type - Service Guide, Admin Guide, Release Notes, etc.
- Confidentiality - public / internal / restricted ceiling
- Tags - free-form labels you set at upload time

Each result shows a relevance score, the excerpt of text that matched, and the source document. Your search terms are highlighted in amber in the result text so you can spot them at a glance. Click **"Show metadata"** to see the full record.

PDF PAGE SCROLLING:

Drag the vertical scrollbar, use the mouse wheel, or enter a page number to move through a rendered PDF. The viewer loads the pages at the current scroll position and a small nearby buffer, including after large jumps. Page-number, Next/Previous, and search-result jumps move immediately.

A brief **"Loading page"** message can appear while a page image loads. If an image fails to load, use its **"Retry page"** button. **"Rendering page"** means the local renderer is still preparing that page. Zoom Page and window resizing preserve the reading position.

DOCUMENT VIEWER (in-document search): Click a result to open the source document in the viewer. A small badge in the top-right of the viewer tells you the file type (PDF / DOCX / RTF / TXT / MD). Use Ctrl+F to search inside the open document; matches are highlighted the same way as query results.

TIP — TRY NATURAL QUESTIONS FIRST

Smart match mode blends keyword and semantic search, so a question like "how do I reset the fuser count" usually works better than a bag of keywords. Fall back to Phrase for exact strings and Semantic for meaning-only searches.

Chapter 8

Library Management

Click the Library tab to see everything you've uploaded.

- Edit metadata - click any document to edit its title, tags, confidentiality, and other fields.
- Delete a document - moved to Recovery (see below), never hard-deleted until you say so.
- Find duplicates - the "**Find duplicates**" button scans the library for documents with the same SHA-256 file hash. Groups are shown side-by-side; you pick which copy to keep.
- Manage values - the "**Manage values**" button lists every product model and product family in use, with how many documents use each. Rename one to fix a misspelling everywhere at once, or rename it onto an existing value to merge the two. You are shown how many documents will change before anything happens.

The Library list refreshes on its own whenever another panel changes what's in the library (a restore from Recovery, a merge restore, an auto-cleanup sweep). No manual reload needed.

Chapter 9

Document Types

Settings > Formats contains the Document types list you can tag a document with. Each row can be renamed, given an accent color, reordered, merged, or deleted.

- Renaming - fixes the name everywhere at once. Any filename code pointing at that type follows the rename automatically.
- Merging - the merge button folds one type into another and re-tags every document that used it. Use this for near-duplicates such as "**User Manual**" and "**User Guide**".
- Deleting - removes the type and puts its documents back on the plain "**Document**" type. If you want to keep the tagging, merge instead.

New type names are capitalized for you, so typing "**technical bulletin**" stores "**Technical Bulletin**". Acronyms such as API, MFP and PDF keep their capitals, and names with deliberate mixed case such as HyPAS or MZ9500ci are stored exactly as you type them.

BELOW the Document types list you'll find two editors that teach the uploader to guess a Document type from the filename:

- Filename codes - short letter/digit codes such as OG, SB, or TB1 that map to a Document type. Matched on whole tokens.
- Filename phrases - full phrases such as "**user guide**" or "**release notes**" that map to a Document type. Matched on whole words after normalizing case and punctuation. Longest matching phrase wins.

Codes are checked first. Phrases run only when no code matches, so a code you added won't be second-guessed by a phrase. Neither one ever overwrites a Document type you already picked yourself; both only run when the Document type is still blank or on the "**Document**" fallback. A fresh install ships with seven default phrases (User Guide, Admin Guide, Installation Guide, Quick Start, Release Notes, Troubleshooting Guide, Security Guide) that you can edit or delete any time from Settings > Formats > Filename phrases.

Chapter 10

Managing Values

Product model and Product family are free-text fields on each document, so near-duplicates like **"PA6000x"** and **"PA6000x Series"** can silently split your filter results. Manage values gives you one place to fix them: Settings > System > Manage values.

- Rename - typing a NEW name renames the value on every document using it.
- Merge - typing an EXISTING name folds the two values together, so **"PA6000x"** and **"PA6000x Series"** become one.
- Delete - opens a small reassign dialog. Pick another existing value to merge into, or clear the field on the documents that used it. A delete never loses a document -- it just moves the value in a way you explicitly chose.

Every change updates every affected document at once. There is no undo step, so export a backup first from Settings > Backup / Restore if you want a restore point.

Chapter 11

Managing Duplicates

Uploading the same PDF twice, or merging in a backup that overlaps with your current library, both leave duplicates around. AdvisePoint Docs handles them non-destructively:

1. **FINDING** - the Library "**Find duplicates**" scan groups files by SHA-256 hash. When there are no groups to show, the panel stays hidden so it doesn't take up space in the sidebar.
2. **CHOOSING A KEEPER** - every group lists its copies newest first, with the date each one was added, whether it has rendered pages, and how many chunks it holds. One is pre-selected as the "**keeper**" (typically the one you can actually view - the original file still on disk with its rendered pages intact), and the newest copy is labeled so it is easy to spot. Select any other copy to keep that one instead; the **KEEP** and **QUARANTINE** labels update as you choose, so you can see the outcome before anything moves. The files in a group are byte-for-byte identical, so this is really a choice about which record to keep - its title, document type, tags, product values, and date added. If you re-uploaded a file after correcting its details, keep the newer copy. The other copies are removed from the library but not destroyed.
3. **WHERE THE REMOVED COPIES GO** - every removed duplicate is moved into `%LOCALAPPDATA%\AdvisePoint Docs\deleted\<timestamp>-\<id>\` with a manifest and the original file. Everything stays on disk under a name you can find.
4. **GETTING ONE BACK** - open Settings > Backup / Restore > Recovery. The "**Removed documents**" list shows every quarantined document with its size and when it was removed. Click **Restore** to bring one back into the live library. Restore is a stage-verify-swap: the server unpacks the copy alongside the live data, verifies everything is intact, and only then puts it back. If a document with the same id is already in the library, the restore refuses instead of overwriting.
5. **PERMANENTLY DELETING** - the Recovery panel also has a per-item **Delete** button for a quarantined document you're sure you don't need. It asks for a confirmation and then frees the disk space.
6. **OPT-IN AUTO-CLEANUP** - the Recovery panel has a toggle labeled "**Auto-cleanup quarantined duplicates**". Off by default. When on, the app periodically sweeps **ONLY** quarantined **DUPLICATES** whose keeper is still present in the library, still matches by SHA-256, and is still viewable. Non-duplicate quarantined documents are never touched by the sweep. There's also a "**Run cleanup now**" button when the toggle is on.

Nothing about this pipeline is destructive: every step keeps the original bytes on disk until you explicitly say "**delete permanently**" or turn on the opt-in sweep.

HELP — NOTHING IS DESTROYED BY DEFAULT

Removed duplicates go to a quarantine folder, not the recycle bin. You can restore any of them from Settings > Recovery. Permanent deletion is always an explicit, per-item choice unless you opt in to the auto-cleanup sweep.

Chapter 12

Backup and Recovery

Backups live under Settings > Backup / Restore, laid out as three cards side-by-side.

QUICK BACKUP (Column 1) Pick a folder and click "**Backup Now**" - the whole library (database + rendered pages + originals) is packed into a timestamped ZIP written to that folder.

The folder input has a Browse button that opens the native Windows folder picker (the same one you get from Save As in other apps). If a folder is already typed, the picker opens there; otherwise it uses the last folder you picked for Quick Backup, then falls back to Documents. You can still paste or type a path directly if you prefer.

A live preflight strip under the input tells you at a glance:

- * whether the folder exists and is writable
- * how much free space is there vs how much the backup needs
- * whether the folder lives inside OneDrive / Dropbox / Google Drive / iCloud / Box - if so you get a plain-language warning and a checkbox to acknowledge you understand the risk (sync clients can lock files mid-write).

"Download a copy" is a secondary button that sends the ZIP through the browser to its default download location, without writing to the folder above. Handy for grabbing a copy on a machine where you don't have write access to the chosen folder.

SCHEDULED BACKUPS (Column 2) Pick a destination folder, a cadence (daily / weekly), a time of day, a weekday (weekly only), and a retention count (how many backups to keep before the oldest is deleted). The folder picker works identically to Quick Backup, with its own "**last folder picked**" memory so the two Browse buttons don't share a starting point.

Click "Save schedule" to activate it. The bottom of the card shows the last run's time, status, and size, plus an estimated next-run time. If the last scheduled run failed, a persistent amber banner appears above the card with plain-language failure details and a Try again button.

"Backup now" on the scheduled card runs an immediate scheduled-style backup against the scheduled folder - so if you turn on scheduled backups for the first time you can get a baseline without waiting for 2 AM.

Retention prunes only after a NEWER backup has been written AND verified. If the new run fails, the previous backups stay put - you're never left with only a broken one.

Scheduled runs write their own log at
`%LOCALAPPDATA%\AdvisePoint Docs\backups.log` so you can look
 back at what ran when even after several rotations.

RESTORE FROM BACKUP (Column 3) Click "**Choose file**" (native OS file picker), pick a previously-created backup ZIP, then pick a restore mode:

- **Wipe** - replaces the live library with the backup. Asks for a typed confirmation. Uses stage-verify-swap under the hood: the backup is unpacked into a temporary directory alongside the live data, verified, THEN the swap happens. If verification fails, nothing is replaced. A pre-restore snapshot of the previous data set is kept as `%LOCALAPPDATA%\AdvisePoint Docs.bak-<timestamp>\` so you can put things back if the restore was a mistake.
- **Merge** - adds documents from the backup that aren't in the live library. Documents already present in the live library (matched by id) are skipped, not overwritten.

Library, Recovery, and the header counters all refresh on their own when the restore completes - no manual page reload.

Restores work across machines, Windows accounts, and architectures. From 1.2.1 on, a backup taken on one PC can be restored on any other supported Windows PC, under any Windows account, on either x64 or ARM64, and every document's page images will display correctly after the restore. Backups made by earlier versions restore correctly on 1.2.1 as well; a library restored on 1.2.1 or later self-heals its internal page-image references on the next launch, so no additional action is required.

Pre-restore Snapshots

Every wipe restore keeps a snapshot of what was replaced, under the parent of the data directory (usually `%LOCALAPPDATA%\AdvisePoint Docs.bak-<timestamp>\`). Recovery lists these snapshots so you can see their size and free the space when you're sure you don't need them.

Swapping a snapshot BACK IN is deliberately not offered from the Recovery panel - restoring a whole data directory is safest done with the app closed. The snapshot folder is a full copy you can restore manually with the app closed if you ever need to.

WARNING — A WIPE RESTORE REPLACES YOUR LIBRARY

Choose Merge if you want to add documents from a backup without changing what's already in the library. Every wipe restore keeps a pre-restore snapshot next to your data folder, so a mistake is always recoverable with the app closed.

Chapter 13

Where Your Data Lives

Everything is stored under:

```
%LOCALAPPDATA%\AdvisePoint Docs\  
  advisepoint.db      <- the SQLite database  
  pages\              <- rendered page images for the viewer  
  originals\          <- the source files you uploaded  
  deleted\            <- quarantined documents (see Managing  
                        Duplicates). Each subfolder has  
                        the manifest + original + pages  
                        needed to restore it, or you can  
                        just delete the folder in File  
                        Explorer to free the space.  
  server.log           <- rolling log for diagnosing crashes  
  backups.log          <- rolling log for scheduled backups
```

Snapshots created by a wipe restore live one level up:

```
%LOCALAPPDATA%\AdvisePoint Docs.bak-<timestamp>\
```

That data folder survives reinstalls and updates. If you ever want a truly fresh start, close the app and delete %LOCALAPPDATA%\AdvisePoint Docs\ - the next launch recreates an empty database.

Chapter 14

Troubleshooting

- **"Windows protected your PC"** popup: Expected the first time you run **"Setup Icon (run once).bat"** or, if you skip that, the first time you run **"Start AdvisePoint Docs.bat"**. Click **"More info"** then **"Run anyway"**. Both launchers clear the **"downloaded"** flag from every other file in the folder, so subsequent launches should NOT show the popup.

If you ever see it again after setup, you can also strip the flag from a PowerShell window in the app folder:

```
Get-ChildItem -Path "C:\path\to\AdvisePoint Docs" -Recurse | Unblock-File
```

Or, before extracting, right-click the .zip in File Explorer, choose Properties, and tick **"Unblock"** - that clears the flag at the source.

- Antivirus flags node.exe: This is the standard Node.js runtime from nodejs.org. If your antivirus is aggressive, add the AdvisePoint Docs folder to its exclusions list.
- Port 5000 is already in use: Close whatever else is using it (another AdvisePoint Docs window, or another local dev server). The start script tries to free the port automatically.
- Browser opens but nothing loads: Wait 5-10 more seconds and refresh. The server takes a moment to come up on first launch.
- PDF upload takes forever: Large PDFs (500+ pages) can take 30-60 seconds. This is normal. Look at the console window for progress.
- **"Reconnecting..."** banner during a long operation: Backups, restores, and large uploads can hold the loopback connection open long enough for the reconnect probe to blink. The banner is suppressed during known-busy operations so you shouldn't see it in normal use. If it does appear, wait for the op to finish; the app reconnects automatically.
- Library counter doesn't match what I see in the list: If you're on a build older than 1.0.14 you may need to refresh the page after a delete/restore. From 1.0.14 on, the list and header counters refresh automatically after Recovery restores, Library deletes, backup restores, and auto-cleanup sweeps.
- An update failed / the app won't start after updating: The updater keeps the previous build as dist.bak next to the new dist folder. To roll back manually: close the app, rename dist to dist.broken, rename dist.bak to dist, and relaunch.
- Restore says **"id already in use"**: The Recovery panel refuses to overwrite a live document with a quarantined one that has the same id. This is deliberate - it keeps a mistaken Restore click from stomping on a document you edited after removing the earlier copy. Delete or export the live document first if you want the quarantined version back.

TIP — CHECK THE LOG BEFORE ASSUMING THE WORST

%LOCALAPPDATA%\AdvisePoint Docs\server.log is a rolling log of everything the app did in this session. Most "it won't start" and "upload failed" questions are answered by the last few lines.

Chapter 15

Technical Details

- Runtime: Portable Node.js 20 LTS (bundled - no install required)
- Database: SQLite via better-sqlite3
- Extraction: pdf-parse for PDFs, mammoth for DOCX, native RTF parser, pdf.js for page rendering (with cMap and standard font support so PowerPoint-exported PDFs render correctly)
- Search: TF-IDF hybrid retrieval (vector + keyword)
- Integrity: SHA-256 hashes on uploaded files (duplicate detection) and on backup ZIP contents (restore verification)
- All processing happens locally. No network calls are made except the update check to GitHub and the update download itself when you use the built-in updater.

Chapter 16

Removing the App

Delete the "**AdvisePoint Docs**" folder. To also remove your uploaded documents, delete the %LOCALAPPDATA%\AdvisePoint Docs\ folder and any %LOCALAPPDATA%\AdvisePoint Docs.bak-* snapshot folders left by past restores.

Chapter 17

Version

AdvisePoint Docs 1.2.7 Bundled Node.js: 20.18.1

Chapter 18

Glossary

Backup

A timestamped ZIP containing the SQLite database, rendered page images, and original uploaded files — everything needed to restore the library on the same machine or a different one.

Chunk

A short searchable excerpt of a document, produced by the indexer at upload time. Search results return matching chunks with their parent document.

Confidentiality Ceiling

A per-document setting (public / internal / restricted) that lets you exclude higher-sensitivity documents from a search using the "Show up to" filter.

Dist.bak

A copy of the previous application build kept next to the new one after an update. If the swap fails, the updater restores it automatically. Superseded on the next successful update.

Document Type

A metadata category applied at upload time (Service Guide, Admin Guide, Release Notes, etc.). Used for filtering searches. Names are stored in Title Case, and the list is editable in Settings > Document types.

Keeper

In duplicate handling, the document chosen to remain in the library while the other copies are moved to quarantine.

Match Mode

The strategy used to rank a query: Smart (default hybrid), Phrase (exact-phrase), or Semantic (meaning-only).

Merge Restore

A restore mode that adds documents from a backup that are not already in the library. Existing documents with the same id are skipped, never overwritten.

Pre-Restore Snapshot

A copy of the live data directory saved automatically before a wipe restore, under %LOCALAPPDATA%\AdvisePoint Docs.bak-<timestamp>\. You can restore from it manually with the app closed.

Product Family

The top-level product line a document belongs to (e.g. "AdvisePoint", "MZ Series"). Independent from Product model — the two filters do not narrow each other.

Product Model

The specific product a document describes (e.g. "MZ9500ci"). Required at upload time; the primary filtering axis for search.

Quarantine

The `deleted\` folder under the data directory where removed documents are stored non-destructively until you Restore them or delete them permanently.

Recovery Panel

The Settings > Recovery view listing quarantined documents and pre-restore snapshots, with per-item Restore and Delete actions and an opt-in auto-cleanup toggle for duplicates.

Sha-256

A cryptographic hash the app computes over every uploaded file and every backup ZIP. Used to detect duplicate uploads and to verify a backup before restoring from it.

Smartscreen

The Windows security prompt ("Windows protected your PC") shown for files marked as downloaded from the internet. Both AdvisePoint launcher batch files strip that mark from the folder on first run so subsequent launches are silent.

Stage-Verify-Swap

The safety pattern used by the updater and by restore: the new content is unpacked into a staging directory, verified end-to-end, and only then swapped in. If verification fails, nothing is replaced.

Wipe Restore

A restore mode that replaces the entire live library with the backup contents. Requires typed confirmation and creates a pre-restore snapshot.

Chapter 19

Index of Common Tasks

Quick jumping-off points for the things people ask about most often. Each entry points to the chapter that covers it in full.

Check system requirements before installing — Chapter 1 — System Requirements

Estimate disk space for the library — Chapter 1 — System Requirements

Install for the first time — Chapter 2 — Quick Start

Update to a newer version — Chapter 3 — Updating

Move the app off OneDrive — Chapter 4 — Install Location

Upload a document — Chapter 5 — Adding Your Own Documents

Run a search — Chapter 6 — Searching

Filter results by product family — Chapter 6 — Searching

Edit a document's metadata — Chapter 7 — Library Management

Find and clean up duplicates — Chapter 8 — Managing Duplicates

Restore a document you removed — Chapter 8 — Managing Duplicates

Take an ad-hoc backup — Chapter 9 — Backup and Recovery

Schedule automatic backups — Chapter 9 — Backup and Recovery

Restore from a backup file — Chapter 9 — Backup and Recovery

Find your data folder — Chapter 10 — Where Your Data Lives

Resolve SmartScreen or antivirus warnings — Chapter 11 — Troubleshooting

Roll back a failed update — Chapter 11 — Troubleshooting

Uninstall completely — Chapter 13 — Removing the App

Look up a technical term — Chapter 14 — Glossary

Colophon

This is the User Guide for AdvisePoint Docs version 1.2.7, document revision 1.2.7, dated September 18, 2026. It ships inside the application as a seeded welcome document so a fresh install has something to search and read on day one. Body text is set in Times Roman; headings and callouts in Helvetica. The guide is generated from `packaging/README.txt` at build time — the source-of-truth for what the application does.

For issues or suggestions, use the in-app feedback path or update to the latest release from Settings > Updates.